

GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

Saturday, 26 September 2026

Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 25 September 2026 US close. All times GMT+8.

Weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know. Figures are Friday settles from TradingView and Financial Modeling Prep captured 11:22 GMT+8 Saturday; week-on-week moves are Friday-to-Friday closes. Sources and verification notes at the back.

1. Weekly market snapshot

INSTRUMENT	FRI CLOSE	WEEK	YTD	NOTE
S&P 500	7,743.41	+1.2%	+13.1%	Monday/Tuesday closes of 7,764–7,765 were the week’s high; Friday sits 0.9% below the 7,816.70 record. Three up-days, two down; volume light into quarter-end.
Nasdaq Composite	27,068.72	+2.1%	+16.5%	Meta and semis did the work; Tuesday close 27,244 was within 0.2% of the 27,288.79 high.
Dow Jones	51,828.62	+0.3%	+7.8%	Snapped a three-week losing streak on Friday’s +479 pt session; still 5.3% off its 54,744 high.
Russell 2000	2,837.55	-0.8%	+14.3%	Small caps lost to rates; 7.6% below the 3,069.71 high. Hedgeye TREND bearish.
US 10Y yield	5.17%	+17 bp	5.00% → 5.17%	Intraday 5.225% Thursday — highest since July 2007. Week’s move driven by PMI, oil and an ugly 5Y auction.
US 2Y yield	4.86%	≈ +15–20 bp*	—	Curve bear-steepened; 2s10s ≈ 31 bp . *Friday-to-Friday 2Y change not independently confirmed.
US 30Y yield	5.49%	higher	—	Touched 5.50% — highest since 2004. Long end led the sell-off.
Dollar (DXY)	101.03	+0.8%	+2.9%	Two-month high; best two-week gain in six months (+1.9%). 52-week high 101.80 within reach.
Gold (spot)	\$4,285	-2.3%	-0.8%	Futures 4,424.9 → 4,321.2. Now 23% below the \$5,599 peak; real yields and the dollar are the headwind. Hedgeye TREND neutral.
Silver (spot)	\$64.29	-3.5%	-11.2%	Futures 67.15 → 64.80; gold/silver ratio 66.8. Physical bid on dips but TREND bearish.
Brent / WTI	\$104.32 / \$92.41	+0.4% / -3.8%	+71% / +61%	Front-month settles (see note). Brent–WTI spread \$12.68 , widest since May, on US diesel-export restriction talk. WTI Friday-to-Friday from Yahoo’s 96.08 settle.
Bitcoin	\$83,916	+3.8%	-4.1%	Monday high \$87,397 (best since January) on a record \$999m single-day ETF inflow; faded as flows slowed to \$191m by Thursday.

Green = up, red = down, amber = flat/unverified. Index weekly and YTD figures reconcile to the Associated Press Friday wire (S&P +1.2%, Dow +0.3%, Nasdaq +2.1%, Russell -0.8%). Brent: two data feeds settle the front month at 104.32; AP and Yahoo Finance quoted “below \$98–99” on Friday, which we could not reconcile — verify the contract before acting. Oil YTD figures are TradingView continuous-contract fields.

2. TL;DR

The bond market broke 5% and equities did not care — yet. The 10-year hit **5.225%** (highest since 2007) and the 30-year **5.50%** (highest since 2004) after a five-year-high flash PMI (**58.4**) and the second-largest 5-year auction tail on record; two Fed officials said another hike is coming. The S&P still gained **+1.2%** and the Nasdaq **+2.1%** because **Meta (+12.9%)**, **Microsoft (+4.5%)** and a semiconductor squeeze (**SOXX +7.4%**, AMD past \$1 trillion) re-rated the AI-agent trade. Beneath the surface it was a narrow tape: small caps fell, utilities and REITs were sold, credit ETFs slipped.

Oil eased into the weekend (**WTI \$92.41**) on Reuters reports of a phased US–Iran deal to reopen Hormuz, Xi’s state visit produced a tariff-truce extension to **10 January** and little else, and the dollar posted its best two weeks in six months while gold lost another 2%. Next week is the real test: **PCE (Wed)**, **ISM (Thu)**, **payrolls (Fri)**, **Micron (Tue)** and quarter-end.

3. The big picture — what the week meant

- Five per cent is no longer a forecast, it is the price.** The 10-year went from 5.00% to 5.17% (intraday 5.225%), the 5-year cleared **5.033%** at Wednesday’s \$70bn auction with a **3.1 bp tail** (second-largest on record for the tenor; indirects fell to 54% from 62%, dealers ate ~\$11bn), and Thursday’s 7-year also tailed. New York Fed’s Williams (Thursday, London) called another hike by year-end “a reasonable way of thinking about it”; Governor Barr (Wednesday) said “further policy adjustments are likely to be needed”. Polymarket prices a 25 bp hike on 27–28 October at **67%**; CME-based reads after Williams were nearer 77%. The MOVE index rose **26%** on the week to 96. Rick Rieder’s line — “not a crisis but an eye-opener” — is the consensus framing.

Read: Duration stays a short on TREND, but the tactical top of the range arrived on Friday: Hedgeye covered 50–100 bp of its TLT/LQD/HYG shorts at 5.21 on the 10-year and said it will reload higher. With a 5% risk-free rate the equity multiple only holds for names with visible earnings acceleration; everything financed with leverage — REITs, utilities, private equity, small caps — is the funding leg.

- Growth is accelerating, not slowing — which is why yields are rising.** The S&P Global flash composite PMI printed **58.4** (manufacturing **57.0** vs 53.6 expected, services **58.7** vs 56.0), the fastest output growth in over five years, with employment growth the strongest since June 2022 and input costs rising at the steepest rate since October 2022. Jobless claims fell to **197k**; core capital-goods orders rose **+1.6%** (vs +0.8%); Q3 GDP trackers sit at 3–5%. The consumer is the exception: Michigan sentiment fell to **48.1**, a four-month low, with one-year inflation expectations at **4.6%** as petrol nears \$4.50 and diesel hits a record.

Read: This is textbook #Quad2 (growth up, inflation up) and Hedgeye’s nowcast for US inflation rose another 27 bp. Own pricing power and inflation beneficiaries (energy, refiners, industrials with backlog, health-care AI), short the rate-sensitive laggards. The bear case is not recession — it is that the Fed has to hike into a 5% ten-year.

- The AI trade rotated from GPUs to agents — and to the CPUs that run them.** Meta added roughly **\$200bn** of market value on Monday alone (**+11.4%**) after its Muse personal agent topped the iOS download charts; Wells Fargo lifted its target to \$796 and Zuckerberg said Muse stays free and “takes a small fee from transactions” with Walmart, Best Buy, Sephora, Expedia and Instacart plugged in. Microsoft (**+4.5%**) merged consumer and enterprise Copilot into one agentic product with usage-based billing; Oppenheimer went to \$570. Intel (**+13%**), Arm and AMD (**+12.6%**, first close above a **\$1 trillion** cap) rallied on server-CPU demand for agents, and Akamai signed an **\$11.6bn**, seven-year CPU-compute contract with Anthropic that carries warrants over ~5% of the company. Nvidia was flat and trades under **17x** forward earnings, a decade low; Oracle fell **-7%** after invoking force majeure on its 2.45 GW Project Jupiter site over a delayed gas pipeline.

Read: Leadership inside AI is migrating to monetisation (agents, software, CPUs) and away from pure capex beneficiaries. The crack to watch is financing: Oracle spent \$28.5bn of capex last quarter with **-\$5bn** free cash flow, and its cost of capital just went up with everyone else’s. Hedgeye flipped Meta from short to long on signal and keeps Microsoft near the top of its buy list; its software Signal Strength names (OKTA, SNOW, TEAM, NET, GTLB) remain the expression.

- Oil: the Hormuz premium is leaking out of the front, not the structure.** WTI fell **-3.8%** to \$92.41 after Reuters reported US and Iranian negotiators discussing a phased deal — Hormuz transit in exchange for lifting the US blockade and access to ~\$12bn of frozen assets — with Witkoff meeting Araghchi in New York. Brent held near \$104 because the physical side got worse: Saudi Arabia intercepted Houthi missiles, an Iranian adviser threatened the Indian Ocean, and the 4 mb/d East-West pipeline has been shut since the 10 September drone strikes. Only 13 vessels crossed Hormuz on Thursday. The Brent–WTI spread at **\$12.68** is the widest since May.

Read: Energy longs are a range trade now: Hedgeye keeps Brent (BNO) bullish TREND with ~\$97 as the level that must break, added tankers (BWET) and holds refiners (CRAK) on the crack-spread. Polymarket puts “Hormuz traffic normal by 31 December” at only 24% and “blockade ended by 31 December” at 62% — the market believes in a deal but not in normal flows. Petrol at \$4.50 is what is showing up in consumer sentiment.

- **Xi in Washington: pageantry, a truce extension, no chips.** The 23–25 September state visit produced a two-month extension of the tariff truce to **10 January 2027**, a proposed US–China “Board of Trade”, an AI “dialogue” channel (Greer: a “red phone”) and two pandas for Atlanta. Nothing on soybeans, Boeing, rare earths, fentanyl, TikTok or export controls; Perdue said “no change” on Taiwan; Trump told Xi Chinese satellite support for Iran was “unacceptable”. USTR promised trade details on Monday. Korea’s KOSPI reclaimed **7,000** in a Chuseok-shortened week as memory-chip exports ran **+351%** y/y in the first 20 days of September.

Read: A November tail risk is deferred, not removed. Nvidia’s guidance still assumes zero China data-centre revenue, so any licensing thaw is optionality worth ~7% of forecasts — not a base case. Memory remains the cleanest way to own the AI capex cycle in Asia; Micron reports Tuesday.

- **Dollar up, gold down, bitcoin up with the dollar.** DXY gained **+0.8%** to 101.03 (best two-week run in six months), the euro slipped below 1.14 and the yen touched 158.84 before recovering to 157.28. Gold lost **−2.3%** and silver **−3.5%** on real yields; gold is now 23% off its peak. Bitcoin gained **+3.8%** to \$83,916 with \$2.8bn of six-day ETF inflows and its 15-day correlation to the dollar flipped to **+0.68**.

Read: Hedgeye’s framing: swap “units of gold for units of bitcoin” while the dollar signal is bullish — gold sits below minimum position size on a neutral TREND, bitcoin and ether were bought again on Thursday’s dip. A 5% nominal yield with a strong dollar is the worst regime for non-yielding metals; do not average down until TRADE and TREND turn.

4. Rates, currencies & commodities

Rates & credit

- **Curve:** 2Y **4.86%**, 5Y **4.99%**, 10Y **5.17%**, 30Y **5.49%**. The move was a bear-steepener — long end up faster than short — after the 5Y auction (5.033%, 3.1 bp tail, bid-to-cover 2.21) and a weak 7Y. The 10Y’s 5.225% Thursday print was the highest since July 2007; the 30Y’s 5.50% the highest since 2004.
- **Credit sold as duration, not as default:** HYG **−0.9%** to 77.86 (52-week low 77.67), LQD **−1.4%** to 103.21, TLT **−2.6%**. Hedgeye holds all three as bearish TREND shorts but covered 50–100 bp on Friday at the top of the 10Y range; PFIx (rate hedge) **+9.8%** on the week.
- **Europe is worse:** Bund 10Y at the highest since 2011 (above 3.3%), French 10Y highest since 2008 and 30Y since 2003, OAT–Bund spread above **90 bp** (widest since 2012). The ECB hiked to **2.50%** on 10 September; markets price ~85 bp more by end-2027 with December fully priced and October live.
- **Vol:** MOVE 96.0 (**+26%** w/w; Hedgeye measures bond vol +37% w/w); Keith called it a “bone rattler” and one of the largest one-month moves ever.

Currencies

- **DXY 101.03 +0.8%** — hot US data plus a hawkish Fed; the 101.80 52-week high is the next level and Hedgeye’s range top is 101.65 (bullish TREND).
- **EUR/USD 1.1391 −0.8%**; **GBP/USD 1.3243 −0.9%** (UK services PMI at a three-month low with rising prices); **AUD/USD 0.7025 −1.2%** as Australian yields “went vertical” and manufacturing PMI fell to 49.3.
- **USD/JPY 157.28 +0.3%** — traded to 158.84 Thursday as hopes of aggressive BoJ tightening faded, then reversed Friday; intervention talk is back. **USD/KRW 1,355 (won +1.7%)** on chip-export flows; **USD/CNH 6.719**, steady through the summit.

Commodities

- **WTI \$92.41 −3.8%, Brent \$104.32 +0.4%** — see theme 4. RBOB **−4.4%** Friday to \$3.19; US diesel at an all-time high. Natural gas \$3.20 (Hedgeye bullish, range 2.89–3.33).
- **Gold \$4,285 spot −2.3%** (futures basis), **silver \$64.29 −3.5%, platinum \$1,779 +1.3% Fri**. Copper spot **\$6.67/lb**, roughly +2.5% on the week (TradingView field, not independently confirmed) and a bullish TREND — the one metal that trades on growth rather than real yields.
- **Crypto:** BTC \$83,916 **+3.8%**, ETH \$2,688 (≈ +3%). Spot BTC ETFs took \$999m Monday (2026 record), \$715m Tuesday, then \$347m and \$191m; 2026 net flows have swung from −\$5.5bn in June to +\$0.8bn. Roughly \$650–920m of shorts were liquidated on the Monday squeeze.

5. Hedgeye Risk Ranges & regime

Regime: #Quad2 for September (GIP model moved to Quad 2 from Quad 3 in August; July was Quad 4). Friday’s Early Look, “#Quad2 Crushing It!” (07:44 ET / 19:44 GMT+8, Keith McCullough), is the live risk-range set until Monday evening’s note. **Quad path (US Monthly Quad Forecast, Macro Week Summary Notes 25 Sep):** Sep-26 **2** → Oct **2** → Nov **1** → Dec **2** → Jan-27 **2** → Feb **4** → Mar **1** → Apr **1** → May **4** → Jun **3** → Jul **2**. The path was read from the published chart; the February and May Quad 4 prints are what Keith’s “2027 bloodbath” commentary refers to.

INSTRUMENT	RISK RANGE	TREND	FRI CLOSE	WHERE IT SITS (% OF BAND)
10Y UST yield (UST10Y)	4.93–5.21%	Bullish	5.167	5.17 — 85% of band; covered part of bond shorts here
High Yield (HYG)	77.75–78.73	Bearish	77.86	77.86 — 11%, at the floor; oversold
IG Credit (LQD)	103.0–105.0	Bearish	103.21	103.21 — 11%, at the floor
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,546–7,797	Bullish	7,743.41	7,743 — 79%; “selling on green” into the top
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ)	26,397–27,500	Bullish	27,068.72	27,069 — 61%, mid-band
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,812–2,894	Bearish	2,837.55	2,838 — 31%; short, partially covered
Health Care (XLV)	166–172	Bullish	170.7	170.70 — 78%; core long
Software (IGV)	103–110	Bullish	—	no live print captured
Energy (XLE)	61.07–65.99	Bullish	62.04	62.04 — 20%, near the floor: buy-the-dip zone
VIX	14.21–17.84	Bearish	14.88	14.88 — 18%, low end; investable bucket
US Dollar (DXY)	99.98–101.65	Bullish	101.03	101.03 — 63%
WTI (continuous)	87.96–107.99	Bullish	92.41	92.41 — 22%, lower quartile
Natural gas (continuous)	2.89–3.33	Bullish	3.196	3.20 — 70%
Gold spot	4,224–4,383	Neutral	4,284.56	4,285 — 38%; below-minimum position
Copper spot	6.40–6.79	Bullish	6.67	6.67 — 69%
Silver spot	61–65	Bearish	64.29	64.29 — 82%, near the top of a bearish band

Ranges are Hedgeye’s immediate-term Risk Range™ signals from the 25 September Early Look, measured on the series Hedgeye names (spot metals, continuous energy contracts, cash 10Y). Monday’s Early Look could not be retrieved this run (Cloudflare interstitial), so no band-on-band diff is shown. IGV was not in the capture set.

Where we sit

Keith’s Friday tactical shift was to **book gains, not change the thesis**: with the 10-year at the top of its range and TLT/LQD/HYG oversold he covered 50–100 bp of those shorts, covered “more than half” of his Real-Time Alert shorts as the S&P approached its highs with VIX still bearish TREND, and then redeployed selectively — **GitLab and Best Buy added**, more **bitcoin, ether and Block (XYZ)** bought, Brent and refiners kept, **Colombia exited** after a large gain, gold held below minimum. The sector

barbell (long health care, short utilities/industrials/Russell) kept paying: XLU **-3.9%** w/w and -13% over a month; a fresh short in Consumer Discretionary (XLY) went on Tuesday. ETF Pro added Cybersecurity (BUG) on Friday and dropped LVHI, JOET and UFO. The regime read is unchanged — “#Quad2 Crushing It” — with the risks he named being the 1-month/3-month vol relationship near a tipping point for systematic flows, and bond-market volatility at bone-rattling levels.

6. Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	PRICE	WEEK	MKT CAP	P/E (TTM)	READ
Nvidia (NVDA)	225.07	+1.3%	\$5.42tn	28.5x	Flat in a semis melt-up; forward P/E <17x, a decade low. China assumed at zero. Reports 25 Nov.
Apple (AAPL)	341.07	+1.5%	\$4.98tn	39.1x	Quiet grind to within 1% of its 345.34 high; the defensive megacap this week.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	343.92	-1.6%	\$4.19tn	17.3x	-3.7% Wednesday on a new antitrust suit over its AI business and EU data fines; cheapest of the seven.
Microsoft (MSFT)	516.17	+4.5%	\$3.83tn	28.8x	Copilot unified into one agentic enterprise app with usage billing; Oppenheimer to \$570. Still only +6.6% YTD.
Amazon (AMZN)	249.67	-1.6%	\$2.69tn	20.1x	Faded from Monday's 258; no company news — funding leg for the Meta/MSFT rotation.
Meta (META)	751.66	+12.9%	\$1.92tn	28.3x	Muse agent tops iOS charts; Wells to \$796; free-plus-transaction-fee model. Fell 3.3% Friday from 777.59.
Tesla (TSLA)	372.11	+2.1%	\$1.47tn	346x	Roadster reveal 1 Oct (“success not guaranteed, excitement is”); Semi event 24 Sep. Still -18.7% YTD.

Leadership read. The seven added roughly **\$440bn** of value on the week, most of it Meta (~\$220bn) and Microsoft (~\$165bn) — the two names with a new agent monetisation story — while the capex-heavy trio (Alphabet, Amazon, Nvidia) went sideways to down. That is the market saying it will now pay for AI revenue lines, not AI cost lines. Hedgeye’s signal flipped Meta from short to long earlier in the year and it remains long; Microsoft is “near the top of the list” of what Keith would buy. Watch Friday’s Meta reversal (-3.3% from Thursday’s 779.82 52-week high, roughly 6% below the August-2025 record) as the first test of whether the Muse re-rating holds through quarter-end rebalancing.

7. Positioning & options

- **VIX 14.87** (14.81 → 14.87 on the week; Thursday close 15.67). Equity vol refused to follow bond vol: MOVE +26% against a flat VIX is the widest divergence of the year. VIX is bearish TREND in Hedgeye’s model and inside the “investable bucket” (range 14.21–17.84); 52-week low 13.38.
- **Gamma:** SPX dealer gamma is back modestly positive (Tier1Alpha throttle 2.67 vs 10-day realised vol 11.7 on 24 Sep) — dips get bought mechanically. Keith’s caveat: the 1-month/3-month vol relationship is near the tipping point that turns systematic flows negative again, hence “selling on green”.
- **Credit:** HYG -0.9%, LQD -1.4% — spreads are not blowing out; the ETFs are falling with duration. HYG at its 52-week low and both at the floor of their Hedgeye ranges argue for tactical covers, which is what happened Friday.
- **Breadth:** Thursday’s flat S&P had 65% of constituents down; equal-weight RSP **-0.6%** against cap-weight **+1.2%**. The rally is Meta, Microsoft and semis.
- **Prediction markets:** October hike 67% (Polymarket); ceasefire holds through 30 Sep 87%; Hormuz normal by year-end 24%.

Net: Low equity vol, high bond vol, positive gamma and narrow breadth is a regime that grinds higher until a catalyst — next week supplies three (PCE, ISM, payrolls). Cheap index puts are the sensible overlay; the better expression of the risk is short the rate-sensitives, not short the index.

8. Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	FRI CLOSE	WEEK	NOTE
Technology (XLK)	196.27	+3.5%	Semis (SOXX +7.4%) and Microsoft; within 1.3% of the 198.73 52-week high.
Communication Svcs (XLC)	112.96	+1.9%	Meta did all of it; Alphabet a drag.
Health Care (XLV)	170.70	+1.4%	Hedgeye core long; health-care AI basket +18.8% in a month.
Industrials (XLI)	170.43	+0.4%	Caterpillar +2.0% Friday; Hedgeye short — partially covered.
Cons. Discretionary (XLY)	110.56	-0.2%	New Hedgeye short (Tue). Tesla up, Amazon and Nike down.
Materials (XLB)	49.80	-0.4%	Copper firm, gold miners soft.
Cons. Staples (XLP)	82.06	-0.9%	Costco +3.1% on the print; rest sold as bond proxies.
Financials (XLF)	54.84	-1.8%	Banks lower on the week despite a steeper curve; GS/MS/BAC sit on Hedgeye’s Signal Strength short list.
Real Estate (XLRE)	41.56	-2.3%	5% ten-year; second-worst sector.
Energy (XLE)	62.04	-3.5%	Crude -3.8%; now at the floor of a bullish Hedgeye range (61.07).
Utilities (XLU)	39.51	-3.9%	Hedgeye’s biggest sector short; -13% in a month, 52-week low 39.12.

Leaders: semiconductors (SOXX +7.4%, SMH, AMD/Intel/Arm), software (IGV names), Meta, health care. **Laggards:** utilities, energy, REITs, financials, small caps (IWM ≈ -1%), long bonds. **Hedgeye read on where leadership is rotating:** the barbell is long health care and AI winners (health-care AI, software, Meta/Microsoft, bitcoin/ether as “Quad 2 commodities”) against short rate-sensitive laggards (utilities, REITs, industrials, Russell 2000, IG/HY duration) — and on Friday the process started harvesting the shorts and adding to longs (GitLab, Best Buy, cybersecurity via BUG) because the bond move had reached the top of its range. Energy stays bullish TREND despite the week: the sector ETF is at the bottom of its band, which in the process is where you add, not sell.

9. Corporate news

- **Meta (META, +12.9%):** Muse, launched under two weeks ago, passed ChatGPT and Claude on iOS downloads; Monday +11.4% on 48m shares (157% of average) with Wells Fargo to \$796 from \$640. Meta Connect (23–24 Sep): Muse stays free, monetised by a “small fee from transactions” through Walmart, Best Buy, Gap, Sephora, Wayfair, Dick’s, Ulta, Fanatics, Expedia and Instacart; a \$349 camera-free Ray-Ban audio glasses and a \$1,299 headset; 1,500+ developer applications. Reports 28 Oct.
- **Microsoft (MSFT, +4.5%):** consumer and workplace Copilot merged into one enterprise app — chat with task delegation, GitHub-based tools for non-coders, and “Autopilot” background agents — with fixed subscriptions for chat and pay-as-you-go for agent work. Oppenheimer to \$570 (Outperform): “customers are increasingly standardising on Microsoft as the primary enterprise AI platform.” Reports 27 Oct.
- **Costco (COST, +3.1%):** FQ4 revenue **\$95.72bn** (+11%; est. \$94.97bn), EPS **\$6.75** (est. \$6.54) including 15c of tariff refunds, comps **+9.4%** (est. 9%), above-consensus membership fee income; FY EPS \$20.76 on \$303bn revenue. CFO: members “very resilient”.
- **Akamai (AKAM, +3.2% Fri; spiked 15–17% after hours Thursday):** \$11.6bn, seven-year CPU-compute contract with Anthropic, expandable to ~\$20bn; warrants over ~5% of the company at \$111.33 (2% vests on first payment, ~1% per additional \$3bn). Akamai guides \$150–300m revenue in 2027 rising to ~\$1.7bn a year by end-2028 and will spend ~\$5.5bn on capacity.
- **Oracle (ORCL, -7.1%):** sent a force-majeure notice to Blue Owl over Project Jupiter, the 2.45 GW New Mexico data centre, after the gas pipeline for its fuel cells missed a summer deadline (now February) and an air permit decision slipped to 23 Nov. Oracle says the 2028 schedule holds; the stock fell ~4% Thursday. Context: capex \$28.5bn last quarter (vs \$8.5bn), free cash flow ~\$5bn.
- **AMD (+12.6%) / Intel (+13.3%) / Arm:** AMD closed above a \$1 trillion cap for the first time (record 639); Intel +10% Monday on reports of SK Hynix exploring a deal and on server-CPU demand for agents; BofA’s Arya raised his 2030 chip-market estimate to \$3.2tn from \$2.7tn. Applied Materials +9.1%, Micron +6.5% into Tuesday’s print.
- **MGM Resorts (-10% Thu):** Barry Diller’s People Inc. withdrew its \$18bn bid for the rest of MGM after the Caesars buyout approval; keeps its 27% stake.

- **Alphabet (−1.6%):** −3.7% Wednesday after being named in a new antitrust suit over its AI business practices, alongside European data-protection fines; failed to hold \$360.
- **Nvidia (+1.3%):** Bloomberg flagged the forward P/E under 17x — half 2025 levels — despite ~90% projected FY27 revenue growth; Huang attended the Xi state dinner with Altman, Zuckerberg, Bezos, Musk, Cook, Nadella and Pichai.
- **Tesla (+2.2%):** Roadster reveal 1 October (\$5k deposit, \$45k wire, >\$250k price; talk of SpaceX cold-gas thrusters); Semi event 24 Sep. Darden (DRI) fell on an FQ1 miss. Accenture −6.6% and Nike −1.4% ahead of prints around 1 Oct.
- **Next week:** Carnival and CarMax (Tue 29), **Micron (Tue 30 after close; consensus revenue ~\$50.4bn, EPS ~\$30.90, all eyes on FQ1 guide and HBM4)**, Nike and Accenture (~1 Oct, unconfirmed on secondary calendars), Starship Flight 14 (Mon), Tesla Roadster (Thu). Quarter-end Wednesday.

10. Macro data

United States

- **S&P Global flash PMI (Wed 23):** composite **58.4** (prior 56.0), manufacturing **57.0** (cons. 53.6, prior 53.2–53.9), services **58.7** (cons. 56.0, prior 56.5–56.8). Employment strongest since June 2022; input costs steepest since October 2022; Williamson: output growing at the fastest rate for over five years, ~5% annualised, with “severe supply chain bottlenecks”.

Net: *The single most important print of the week — it is what took the 10-year through 5.10% and put October on the table. Growth and inflation accelerating together is Quad 2.*

- **Michigan sentiment, Sep final (Fri): 48.1** (cons. 47.8, Aug 51.7); expectations 46.3 (−10%), current 50.9; 1-yr inflation expectations **4.6%** (from 4.0%), 5-yr 3.4%. Hsu: personal-finance views “weakened about 10%”; sentiment down 20% among Republicans and 13% among Democrats since January.

Net: *The consumer is paying the oil bill. Watch for a services-spending wobble in next week’s personal spending (cons. +0.9%).*

- **Durable goods, Aug (Fri):** headline **0.0%** (cons. −0.3%, prior +0.9% rev.); ex-transport up; core capital goods orders **+1.6%** (cons. +0.8%); core shipments +0.6%.

Net: *Capex is not rolling over — some of it is tariff-driven pre-buying, but it feeds the 3–5% Q3 GDP tracks.*

- **Jobless claims (Thu): 197k** (cons. 201k, −1k); continuing 1.72m. **Regional Feds:** Richmond manufacturing −2, Kansas City 14 (from 10). **Auctions:** 5Y \$70bn at 5.033% (tail 3.1 bp), 7Y also tailed.

Net: *Labour is tight, the deficit is being financed at 5%. Supply, not just inflation, is now in the yield.*

- **Fed speak:** Williams (Thu, London) — another hike by year-end “reasonable”; the Fed under Chair Warsh no longer pre-signals decisions. Barr (Wed) — “further policy adjustments are likely to be needed”; 16 of 18 dots see at least one more hike this year. Context: the 16 September hike to **3.75–4.00%** was unanimous, the first since 2023; August CPI 3.4% y/y, core 2.4% with services re-accelerating.

Net: *A second hike on 27–28 October is the base case (67–77% priced). The Fed is chasing a 5% ten-year, not leading it.*

Europe & UK

- **Flash PMIs (Wed):** Eurozone manufacturing 52.7 (cons. 52.6), services **53.0** (cons. 51.5, highest in nearly a year); France manufacturing 50.3 (cons. 50.9), services 51.4 (cons. 48.3); UK manufacturing 52.0 (from 51.7), services **51.7** (cons. 52.0, three-month low with accelerating prices).

Net: *Europe is in the same Quad with a weaker growth engine and an ECB already hiking (2.50%, October live). Peripheral spreads — OAT–Bund >90 bp — are where the stress shows first; Hedgelye is short Germany and Switzerland on bounces.*

Asia

- **China:** 1Y and 5Y loan prime rates unchanged (Mon 21) for a 16th month; Shanghai ≈ +0.3% w/w, Hang Seng ≈ −0.9% (TradingView fields) — the summit produced no stimulus and no chips. Industrial profits due Sunday.
- **Japan:** flash manufacturing PMI 54.1 (cons. 55.0), services 51.6 (from 52.5); Nikkei higher on the week at 66,364 with the yen weak (TradingView weekly field +2.6%). **Korea:** memory-chip exports \$21.5bn in the first 20 days of September (**+351% y/y**), KOSPI back above 7,000 (≈ +7% w/w per TradingView, holiday-shortened); Samsung +5% on a Goldman 490,000-won target. **Australia:** manufacturing PMI 49.3 (from 52.0), first contraction since March, as yields spiked; ASX −0.4%.

Net: *Asia is bifurcating into memory exporters (Korea, Taiwan, Japan equipment) and oil importers with rising yields (Australia, India — both Hedgelye shorts).*

Next week (all GMT+8)

- Tue 29 Sep 22:00 CB consumer confidence, JOLTS · Wed 30 Sep 20:15 ADP (cons. +70k), 20:30 GDP Q2 third estimate (cons. 1.6%), PCE (Aug), personal income/spending (+0.5%/+0.9%), 21:45 Chicago PMI (cons. 51.2) · Thu 1 Oct 20:30 claims (cons. 199k), 22:00 ISM manufacturing (cons. 55.0), vehicle sales · Fri 2 Oct 20:30 payrolls (cons. +100k, unemployment 4.1%; prior +162k). Government funded to 11 December under the stopgap; midterms 3 November.

11. Geopolitics

- **▲ Iran / Hormuz:** Reuters (Thu) — US and Iranian negotiators in New York (Witkoff–Araghchi) discussing a phased deal: Hormuz reopened in exchange for lifting the US naval blockade (in place since 12 April) and access to ~\$12bn of frozen assets; Araghchi floated reopening within seven days if conditions are met. Obstacles: neither side wants to move first, Iran wants Lebanon and Yemen included, and Israel says another strike on Natanz/“Pickaxe Mountain” is “only a matter of time”. Dennis Ross puts a pre-midterm deal at 30%. Background: the war began 28 February with the killing of Iran’s supreme leader; the Pakistan-brokered ceasefire has held since 8 April and was extended by MoU in June; Hormuz has been effectively closed to Western traffic since 4 May.
- **▼ Gulf escalation:** Saudi Arabia intercepted Houthi missiles Thursday; an Iranian military adviser threatened to widen the conflict to the Indian Ocean; the 4 mb/d East-West pipeline remains shut after the 10 September drone strikes, with reopening talks reported. 13 Hormuz and 27 Bab al-Mandeb crossings Thursday.
- **◆ Prediction markets (Polymarket, Sat morning):** US–Iran ceasefire continues through 30 Sep **87%**; Israel–Iran ceasefire through 31 Oct **85%**; blockade ended by 31 Dec **62%** (by 31 Mar **77%**); Hormuz traffic normal by 31 Oct **9%**, by 31 Dec **24%**; final nuclear deal by year-end **13%**; US invasion before 2027 **14%**; regime falls before 2027 **7%**. Fed 25 bp hike 27–28 Oct **67%**.

- ◆ **US–China:** state visit 23–25 Sep. Delivered: truce extension to 10 Jan 2027, a proposed Board of Trade, an AI dialogue channel with a follow-up within a month, Chinese commitment (per Perdue) to end satellite-imagery support for Iran, two pandas. Not delivered: soybeans, Boeing, rare earths, fentanyl, TikTok, export controls, Taiwan (“no change”). USTR to publish details Monday; Bessent confirmed the truce runs two months past 10 November.
- ◆ **Russia–Ukraine:** Zelensky (Fri) said the US proposed trilateral technical-level talks in the UAE within ~10 days; the Kremlin said a meeting “could happen soon”; Putin said all proposals are on the table but Russia “must weigh its interests”. Zelensky warned Europe of Russian hybrid attacks.
- ◆ **Washington:** shutdown risk for 1 October removed — the stopgap funds government to 11 December (House passed early September; reported signed). Fed Chair Warsh’s first hike is now three weeks old; the Fed has dropped pre-meeting guidance. UNGA High-Level Week (22–25 Sep) was Guterres’s last.

Read: *The market is pricing a deal that ends the blockade but not one that normalises Hormuz — that is the right distinction and it is why Brent holds \$100 while WTI slides. Position for a lower geopolitical premium at the front of the curve and a persistent physical premium in the spread and in refining margins.*

12. Beyond the markets — also worth knowing

Summits, conferences & talks

- UNGA 81 High-Level Week, New York (22–25 Sep): theme “Restoring trust, managing transformation”; climate/just-transition event 23 Sep, sea-level rise 24 Sep, pandemic preparedness 25 Sep; Guterres’s final session before his term ends 31 December. Climate Week NYC runs 20–27 Sep. Meta Connect (23–24 Sep) and the All-In Summit (Musk’s Roadster tease) were the tech set-pieces; the Xi state dinner drew every major AI CEO to one table.

Science & frontier research

- A quiet week for verifiable headline science: the standing story is the AI-in-research wave (Hedgeye’s “Healthcare AI” basket, 10x Genomics +288% since its signal add) rather than a single paper. The Nobel announcements begin the first week of October (Physiology or Medicine first). No major journal-embargo result could be confirmed against a primary source this run.

Space & frontier tech

- Starship Flight 14 — Monday 28 Sep, window opens 20:15 GMT+8** (07:15 CT, 75 minutes) from Starbase: SpaceX’s **first orbital attempt** — an insertion burn ~25 minutes after lift-off, roughly six laps at ~275 km over ~10 hours, and deployment of 26 Starlink V3 satellites that stay up. Ship 41 flies with a reworked heat shield (extra tile fasteners, curved tiles), Booster 21 with new engine filtering and relight software. Everything Artemis needs downstream (propellant transfer, lunar lander) runs through this milestone.

Weather & climate (market-moving)

- The Atlantic still has **no hurricane in 2026** — a satellite-era record for latest first hurricane (previous 11 September); Tropical Depression Six formed 19 September and fizzled. No Gulf threat to production or refining, which matters when diesel is at an all-time high and Hormuz is the only supply story. NOAA maintains its below-normal season call.

Water cooler

- Sport:** the NFL plays its first game in Rio de Janeiro on Sunday; WNBA playoffs open 27 Sep; NASCAR Hollywood Casino 400 at Kansas; LPGA NW Arkansas Championship; WWE/AAA Worlds Collide in Chicago. Note: there is no Ryder Cup this year — Adare Manor hosts in 2027.
- Screen:** “Brothers” (Apple TV — McConaughey and Harrelson as themselves), “American Horror Story” S13 (Hulu), “The Great British Baking Show” S17 with Nigella Lawson as co-judge (Netflix), “Unabomber” (Netflix), “The Love Hypothesis” (Prime), “Tuner” (Paramount+), “A Different World” revival (Netflix).
- Games:** 24 September was the big drop — “Silent Hill: Townfall”, “Control Resonant” and “Total War: Warhammer III – Lords of the End Times”; “Graveyard Keeper 2” landed on the 22nd.

13. Appendix — stock cards

Price = Friday 25 Sep close. Week = Friday-to-Friday. Mkt cap, P/E (trailing) and dividend yield from TradingView at capture; 52-week range and 6-month performance likewise. Key dates from exchange/company calendars via TradingView — treat as unconfirmed until the company confirms. No charts embedded; the 6-month line describes the trend in words.

NVDA — Nvidia \$225.07 +1.3% <i>Earnings 25 Nov</i>	\$5.42tn · P/E 28.5 · yld 0.1% · 52w 164.27–236.54 6-month trend: 6m +32%; a steady uptrend that stalled in September while AMD/Intel ran; 5% off the high. Read: <i>Cheapest it has been in a decade on forward earnings; the market doubts durability of 90% growth. Hedgeye’s AI expression sits elsewhere. Owning the index means owning this.</i>
AAPL — Apple \$341.07 +1.5% <i>Earnings 29 Oct</i>	\$4.98tn · P/E 39.1 · yld 0.3% · 52w 243.42–345.34 6-month trend: 6m +34%; the quietest big winner, grinding to a record on services and a weaker-dollar tailwind now reversing. Read: <i>Defensive megacap with the most expensive multiple of the seven; the dollar’s two-week rally is the near-term risk.</i>
GOOGL — Alphabet \$343.92 -1.6% <i>Earnings 27 Oct</i>	\$4.19tn · P/E 17.3 · yld 0.3% · 52w 235.84–408.61 6-month trend: 6m +24% but 16% off the 52-week high; rolling over since summer on capex and regulatory drag. Read: <i>New AI antitrust suit plus EU fines; failed at \$360. Cheapest of the seven — the market is charging a legal discount.</i>
MSFT — Microsoft \$516.17 +4.5% <i>Earnings 27 Oct</i>	\$3.83tn · P/E 28.8 · yld 0.7% · 52w 349.20–553.72 6-month trend: 6m +43% from the spring low, now within 7% of the record after a summer consolidation. Read: <i>Copilot unification and usage billing are the bull case; Keith puts it near the top of his buy list. Revenue volatility replaces seat predictability.</i>
AMZN — Amazon \$249.67 -1.6% <i>Earnings 29 Oct</i>	\$2.69tn · P/E 20.1 · 52w 196.00–287.20 6-month trend: 6m +21% but 13% off the high; sideways-to-down since August. Read: <i>No news, no bid: the funding leg for this week’s rotation. Watch AWS commentary and capex guide on 29 Oct.</i>
META — Meta Platforms \$751.66 +12.9% <i>Earnings 28 Oct</i>	\$1.92tn · P/E 28.3 · yld 0.3% · 52w 520.26–779.82 6-month trend: 6m +39%; broke out in September on Muse; Monday’s +11% gap took it to a 52-week high, still ~6% under the August-2025 record. Read: <i>Hedgeye’s signal is long after a short-to-long flip; Wells \$796. Friday’s ~3.3% reversal from 777.59 is the first test of the gap.</i>
TSLA — Tesla \$372.11 +2.1% <i>Roadster 1 Oct; earnings 28 Oct</i>	\$1.47tn · P/E 346 · 52w 297.38–498.83 6-month trend: 6m +1%; a wide, volatile range; still ~19% YTD and 25% off the high. Read: <i>Event-driven into 1 October. Deliveries due early October will matter more than thrusters.</i>
AMD — Advanced Micro Devices \$630.63 +12.6% <i>Earnings 3 Nov</i>	\$1.03tn · P/E 162 · 52w 159.33–639.00 6-month trend: 6m +213%; parabolic since spring; first close above \$1tn cap on Monday. Read: <i>Server-CPU-for-agents narrative plus HBM-fed GPUs. Extended; a name to trade the risk range, not to chase.</i>
INTC — Intel \$123.00 +13.3% <i>Earnings 22 Oct</i>	\$650bn · P/E n/m · 52w 32.89–142.35 6-month trend: 6m +182%, +35% in a month: the turnaround trade of 2026, 14% off the high. Read: <i>SK Hynix talks, government backing, price hikes. Revenue +25% y/y last quarter. Momentum, not valuation.</i>

AMAT — Applied Materials \$485.00 +9.1% <i>Earnings 12 Nov</i>	\$385bn · P/E 41.8 · yld 0.4% · 52w 202.87–739.67 6-month trend: 6m +44% but 34% off the 52-week high — a deep correction inside a bull market. Read: <i>Equipment is the lagging leg of the memory cycle; BofA's \$3.2tn 2030 chip-market call is the tailwind.</i>
MU — Micron \$1,082.28 +6.5% <i>Earnings Tue 30 Sep (AMC)</i>	\$1.22tn · P/E 24.5 · 52w 159.97–1,255.00 6-month trend: 6m +201%: memory super-cycle; 14% off the 52-week high. Read: <i>Consensus ~\$50.4bn revenue, ~\$30.90 EPS, ~86% gross margin; the stock trades on the FQ1 guide and HBM4 volume. Korea's +351% chip exports say the quarter is fine.</i>
ORCL — Oracle \$137.10 -7.1% <i>Earnings 14 Dec</i>	\$415bn · P/E 21.5 · yld 1.4% · 52w 114.50–322.54 6-month trend: 6m -3%, -54% over a year: the AI-capex financing casualty, 57% off the high. Read: <i>Force majeure on Project Jupiter is about cash, not demand: \$28.5bn quarterly capex, -\$5bn FCF, rising cost of capital. Avoid until the funding plan is clear.</i>
COST — Costco \$922.77 +3.1% <i>Earnings 10 Dec</i>	\$409bn · P/E 44.4 · yld 0.6% · 52w 844.06–1,096.50 6-month trend: 6m -6%: derated with staples; 16% off the high before this week's bounce. Read: <i>Comps +9.4% and "very resilient" members with petrol at \$4.50 — the best consumer read of the week. Multiple still full.</i>
AKAM — Akamai \$113.94 +9.0% <i>Earnings 10 Nov</i>	\$16bn · P/E 41.1 · 52w 70.82–165.45 6-month trend: 6m -2%: dead money until Thursday night's \$11.6bn Anthropic contract. Read: <i>Seven-year CPU-compute deal, \$5.5bn build, warrants over ~5%. Re-rates the stock from CDN to AI infrastructure — execution risk is the build.</i>
MGM — MGM Resorts \$32.58 wk n/a <i>Earnings 4 Nov</i>	\$8bn · P/E 19.7 · 52w 29.18–51.59 6-month trend: 6m -13%, -25% in a month: the bid premium is gone. Read: <i>Diller's People Inc. walked from \$18bn but keeps 27%. Gaming is on Hedgeye's short list (Flutter, Red Rock). Weekly change not computed — Thursday -10/11%.</i>
TXG — 10x Genomics \$85.71 wk n/a <i>Earnings 4 Nov</i>	\$11bn · P/E n/m · 52w 11.16–86.16 6-month trend: 6m +327%: Hedgeye's #1 Signal Strength stock, +288% since its add; at a 52-week high. Read: <i>The poster child of the "Healthcare AI" basket (+18.8% in a month). Parabolic — size for the volatility. Weekly change not computed.</i>
ACN — Accenture \$176.11 -6.6% <i>Earnings ~1 Oct (unconfirmed)</i>	\$108bn · P/E 14.1 · yld 3.7% · 52w 118.15–291.09 6-month trend: 6m -10%, -35% YTD: the AI-disruption short in services; 40% off the high. Read: <i>Cheap for a reason; the market is pricing agentic AI eating consulting hours. Weekly figure is TradingView's field.</i>
NKE — Nike \$35.75 -1.4% <i>Earnings ~1 Oct (unconfirmed)</i>	\$53bn · P/E 17.0 · yld 4.5% · 52w 35.22–76.97 6-month trend: 6m -31%, -44% YTD: at a 52-week low into the print. Read: <i>Tariffs, China and a turnaround that has not turned; 4.5% yield is the only support. Weekly figure is TradingView's field.</i>

14. Sources & verification

Prices: TradingView scanner (Friday settles, 52-week ranges, market caps, trailing P/E, captured 11:22 GMT+8 Sat 26 Sep), Financial Modeling Prep end-of-day series (indices, gold/silver/Brent futures, BTC, EUR/JPY, Mag7 — Friday-to-Friday), StockAnalysis.com (sector ETFs, credit ETFs, single stocks), Yahoo Finance history (DXY, 10-year, WTI 18 Sep settle). Index weekly and YTD moves reconciled to the Associated Press Friday wire. Yahoo's API throttled the capture, so the live table is single-sourced to TradingView with the cross-checks above.

Hedgeye: Early Look “#Quad2 Crushing It!” (25 Sep, K. McCullough), The Macro Show summary notes (25 Sep; AI-enhanced, reported outside quotation marks), Macro Week Summary Notes (25 Sep, incl. US Monthly Quad Forecast), ETF Pro Plus update (25 Sep). Not available: Monday's Early Look (Cloudflare check blocked the category page, so no band diff), the “Capex | Frisky → Fuego” note (not in subscription), Signal Strength Stocks (content missing on the feed).

Narrative & macro: CNBC, Reuters (via US News/Times of Israel), Yahoo Finance, The Washington Post/AP, TheStreet, Benzinga, 24/7 Wall St., Motley Fool, TradingKey, TechCrunch, Bloomberg (headlines), S&P Global PMI via InvestingLive and Babypips, Advisor Perspectives, TD Economics, TFTC (auction), Economic Weekly, USAGOLD, The National, Seoul Economic Daily, Investing.com, Trading Economics, Polymarket, CBS News, UN News, Teslarati/AIAA, TheWrap, DLCompare, Wikipedia (Iran war timeline, hurricane season).

Not verified / weak marks: 2-year weekly change; copper, natural gas, ether, Accenture and Nike weekly moves (TradingView performance fields only); Brent front-month vs AP/Yahoo sub-\$99 quotes; TheStreet's weekly index figures (+0.63%/+1.21%) disagree with AP and the settle arithmetic and were not used; the 6-month trend lines are descriptive, not charted; Micron consensus from a single secondary source; Nike/Accenture report dates unconfirmed; the stopgap “signed” status is from secondary reporting. Absence of a Hedgeye position change in the notes above is not evidence there was none.

Figures are for the week ending Fri 25 September 2026 close unless noted; verify live prices before acting. Information only, not investment advice.